Kathryn's Reading Practice

Level 2 (about 2.0 to 2.3 grade level) • Words from Word List 6
Read each story out loud. Then answer the questions. Look back at the story to check!

The Space Ship

(fiction)

Jake and his little sister Bree made a space ship out of a big box. Jake drew a blue globe on the side. "This is planet Earth," he said. Bree wanted to bring her toy bird. "Birds can fly in space too!" she said. They got in, and Jake said, "Close the door!" Bree pulled the flap shut. Jake counted down from ten. "Blast off!" they yelled. The box slid on the rug as they rocked it. Then Dad came in with a plate of grapes. "Here is a space snack!" he said. It was the best trip in the whole place.

Questions

1. Who made the space ship?
   a) Jake and Dad
   b) Jake and Bree
   c) Bree and Mom

2. What did Jake draw on the side?
   a) a blue globe
   b) a red star
   c) a bird

3. Why did Bree pull the flap shut?
   a) She was cold.
   b) Jake said to close the door.
   c) The bird got out.

4. What happened right after they yelled "Blast off!"?

a) Dad came in.

b) Jake drew a globe.

c) The box slid on the rug.

5. Why did Dad bring grapes?

a) for a space snack

b) for the bird

c) for lunch at school

How Birds Fly

(nonfiction)

Have you seen *a* bird fly? A bird has very light bones. It flaps its wings to go up. Then it can glide on the wind. When *a* bird glides, its wings stay still. A baby bird can not fly at first. It must grow big feathers. Its mom and dad bring it food in the nest. Then one day, it is time to test its wings. It hops to the edge of the nest and jumps. Flap, flap, flap! At last, the little bird can fly.

Questions

1. What does *a* bird do to go up?

a) It flaps its wings.
b) It sits still.
c) It hops.

2. What happens when *a* bird glides?

a) It eats.
b) Its wings stay still.
c) It falls.

3. Why can *a* baby bird not fly at first?

a) It is sleepy.
b) It must grow big feathers.
c) It is too big.

4. What does the baby bird do right after it hops to the edge of the nest?

a) It jumps.
b) It eats food.
c) It goes to sleep.

5. Who brings the baby bird food?

a) a cat

b) its mom and dad

c) a kid

Answer Key (for grown-ups)

The Space Ship

1. b) Jake and Bree [Who & what]
2. a) a blue globe [Who & what]
3. b) Jake said to close the door. [Why]
4. c) The box slid on the rug. [Sequence]
5. a) for a space snack [Why]

How Birds Fly

1. a) It flaps its wings. [Who & what]
2. b) Its wings stay still. [Who & what]
3. b) It must grow big feathers. [Why]
4. a) It jumps. [Sequence]
5. b) its mom and dad [Who & what]